LFH Case No. 095.

Feb 22nd 1875

Dear Ettie,

I begin to think it is about time to answer your letter, I am quite well but feeling very tired just now for I have been up for the last two or three evenings there is a great deal of sickness around & you know I can never refuse to do any thing that I can do. I can do so (pg. 2) little. I am almost homesick tonight do not expect to go home again before my school closes. How are all the people up there. Is your society a success now. I have just written a letter home haven't heard from my folks for ten days I do not know what has happened them. do you ever see any of them my school is very pleasant it grows more and more so. I tell you <u>you</u> just ought to know one of my boys he is the pure gold I just like him if he was older I might like to adopt him but he is too young. I had a call from a gentleman a few days since & I will tell you (pg. 3) about him some of these times but would not write it to you.

Are you intending to teach next summer or do you think of taking a select school of one[1] If you do <u>that</u> remember I am to stand by you in that terrable ordeal it is getting late & I must say good night for there is a coupl here that begin to think that they can <u>dispense without my company</u> just as well as not & (allow one the slang) you know how it is yourself.

So good night

Pleasant dreams. Write soon

Ever your own

E.J.T.[2]

On the top margin of page 1 written vertically is the following post script:

"P.S. did you get any valentines"

1. "our?"
2. Emma Jane Thayer. See below.

Created: 02/24/2025,16:14:00; Last revised: 03/06/2025,02:55:00; Words: 1179; Char.: 5084; DOC. Size: <Document Size>; Version: <Version Numbers>.; File Name: 1875 2 22 Letter - Emma J. Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 095.docx; No. of pages: 3. Path: 1875 2 22 Letter - Emma J. Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 095.docx. ©2025 by Craig G. Campbell, Author/Publisher, 2431 Highcrest Road, Rockford, IL 61107. LairdGordn@aol.com. All rights reserved. No part of this letter may be reproduced or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic or mechanical, including photocopying, recording, or by any information storage and retrieval system, without written permission from the Author/Publisher. Originally transcribed 6/12/2005. **LFH Case No. 095**.

LFH Case No. 095. 22 February 1875 Letter Emma J. Thayer,[3] Unknown City, State to Juliette A. E. Flagler, Janesville, Wisconsin. Data: 1 letter sheet; 1 letter written; Author's sex M/F; 1 author; author's age 23; Env.; No return address on env.; Envelope embossed with capital letter "T" in upper-left corner. The envelope is graphed with neon-teal squares. The stamp has been cut out; cotton-fibre; doc. cond. fair; legibility fair; Cursive; Purple ink; Embossed with a "T" in ulhc; Graph purple-lined; No watermark; No letterhead; Complimentary close; Separate signature line; Thayer; Written Monday; Evening; Winter; 11 x 17.6 cm (4.33 x 6.93 in); 1 date; Doc. cond. fair; Legibility poor; cotton-fibre; Wim; No crossing Letters; Heading; Per. formal greeting; Separate signature line; Postscript reads: "P.S. did you get any valentines"; Originally transcribed 06/12/2006.

Emma Thayer was the daughter of Lindley M. & Elizabeth Thayer both born in Maine. The Thayer's were neighboring farmers who lived in Sec. 12 of Janesville Township, Rock Co., Wis., adjacent to the Flagler's who lived in Section 1. She was born in 1853 which was the same year that Juliette A. E. Flagler was born. Both were teachers and probably attended Milton Academy together.

Emma begins her letter to her friend Juliette writing "I begin to think it is about time to answer your letter," and then states she is "quite well but feeling very tired just now for I have been up for the last two or three evenings." The reason for this is "there is a great deal of sickness around & you know I can never refuse to do any thing that I can do. I can do so little." She adds that "I am almost homesick tonight do not expect to go home again before my school closes." She asks Ettie how "are all her people up there. Is your society a success now?" She tells Ettie that she has just written a letter home because she hasn't heard "from my folks for ten days I do not know what has happened them." Emma asks "do you ever see any of them?" Emma then describes her school writing "my school is very pleasant it grows more and more so." She writes "I tell you <u>you</u> just ought to know one of my boys he is the pure gold I just like him if he was older I might like to adopt him but he is too young."[4] This revelation is followed saying that she had a call from a "gentleman a few days since & I will tell you about him some of these times but would not write it to you." Her discussion would only be shared in person. In Emma's second paragraph she asks Ettie if she intends to teach school next summer "or do you think of taking a select school of one." She says "If you do <u>that</u> remember I am to stand by you in that terrible ordeal." What she means by "a select school of one" is hard to interpret. She writes that it is getting late and she must say good night "for there is a couple here that begin to think that they can <u>dispense without my company</u> just as well as not & (allow one the slang) you know how it is yourself." Emma's inference is vague but obviously Ettie knows. Emma concludes her letter "So good night Pleasant dreams. Write soon, Ever your own E.J.T." In her postscript on page one she asks, "P.S. did you get any valentines." Discovering Emma's identity was a challenge but a letter

3. In this letter the embossed "T" on the envelope is a strong clue that it is Emma J. Thayer. The purple ink is also seen in later letters. See: *1874 9 24 Emma Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 536*. Emma J. Thayer's name was also deduced by comparing the calligraphy from *1872 4 9 Letter Emma Thayer to Juliette A. E. Flagler, 061* and *1873 12 3 Letter Emma Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 062*. In both letters, the calligraphy matches as well as the general tone and syntax. See also: *1876 9 8 - Letter – Emma J. Thayer To Juliette A E Flagler, 132*. This letter has the same syntax, sentence structure, etc. L. M. Thayer were neighbors of the Flagler family in Sec. 12 just south of the Flagler farm in Section 1 in Janesville Township in *Evert's* 1873 map.

4. Such a statement would have you in jail in 2025.

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dated 8 Sept. 1876 from Bennett Valley, California, clarified the issue. In this letter Emma details a transcontinental railroad trip from the Midwest to Bennet Valley in Sonoma County. In researching the Thayer Family genealogy I came across a reference to Emma Jane Thayer in the 1880 U.S. Census for Bolinas, Marin Co., California. In the 1880 census report Emma's birth is "about 1853" in Wisconsin and her mother and father's birthplace is Maine" which correlates with the 1860 & 1870 U.S. Census for Janesville, Rock Co., Wis. In the 1880 U.S. Census for Bolinas, Marin Co., her occupation is listed as "School teacher." Both the Flagler and Thayer families appear on the same page in the 1860 and 1870 census reports for Janesville, Emma being 18 and Juliette 16. Similarly, in the Wisconsin Marriage records 1820-2004, Emma Jane Thayer married Josiah Robert Morrow on 15 Jan. 1881 in Janesville, Wisconsin. See: Emma J. Thayer wrote eight letters to Juliette A. E. Flagler: *1872 4 9 Letr. Emma Thayer to Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 061*; *1873 12 3 Letr. Emma Thayer To Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 62*; *1874 9 16 Letter - 'E' Emma Thayer To Juliaette A. E. Flagler, 078*; *1875 2 22 Letr. Emma J. Thayer To Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 095*; *1875 3 14 Letr. 'E' Emma Thayer To Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 099*; and *1874 9 20 - Letter Emma Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 536*; *1876 9 8 Letter Emma J. Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 132*; and *1879 5 3 Letter - Emma J. Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 186*.

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